

FOR FAMILIES, EXECUTORS & TRUSTED PROFESSIONALS

# EstateReady

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Prepare while everyone  
can be part of the conversation.

EstateReady brings family, executor and professional teams  
together before responsibility arrives.

Seasonal Perspective. Daily Discipline.



## BEFORE AN ESTATE EXISTS

# Your Will may be ready. Is your Executor?

One day, someone you trust will have to step in while they are grieving. They should not have to start from scratch.

## Before that day, there is time to talk.

Make sure your Executor knows they have been chosen, where the Will is, who to call and what matters to you.

## Give your Executor a place to start.

Invite them to meet Northern Light while you are still here to be part of the conversation.

They can ask questions. You can explain what matters. And when the time comes, they already know who to call.

## WHAT TO ORGANIZE

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Will & key documents

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Assets & liabilities

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Bank & investment accounts

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Insurance & bequests

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Lawyer, accountant &  
key contacts

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Companies, trusts &  
other interests

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Good estate planning prepares the documents.  
EstateReady prepares the people.

## PHASE 1 • FAMILY CONTINUITY

# When a family becomes an estate.

Every estate begins the same way: with the loss of someone you love.

## You are allowed to grieve and to be deeply human.

In the first days, an Executor is rarely thinking like an Executor. They are still a grieving spouse, son, daughter, sibling, parent or friend.

## You do not have to solve everything at once.

There will be financial and legal responsibilities, but not everything needs to happen at once. First, life still needs to function.

### KEEP LIFE FUNCTIONING

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Pay the mortgage

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Keep the lights on

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Buy groceries

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Plan the funeral

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Support one another

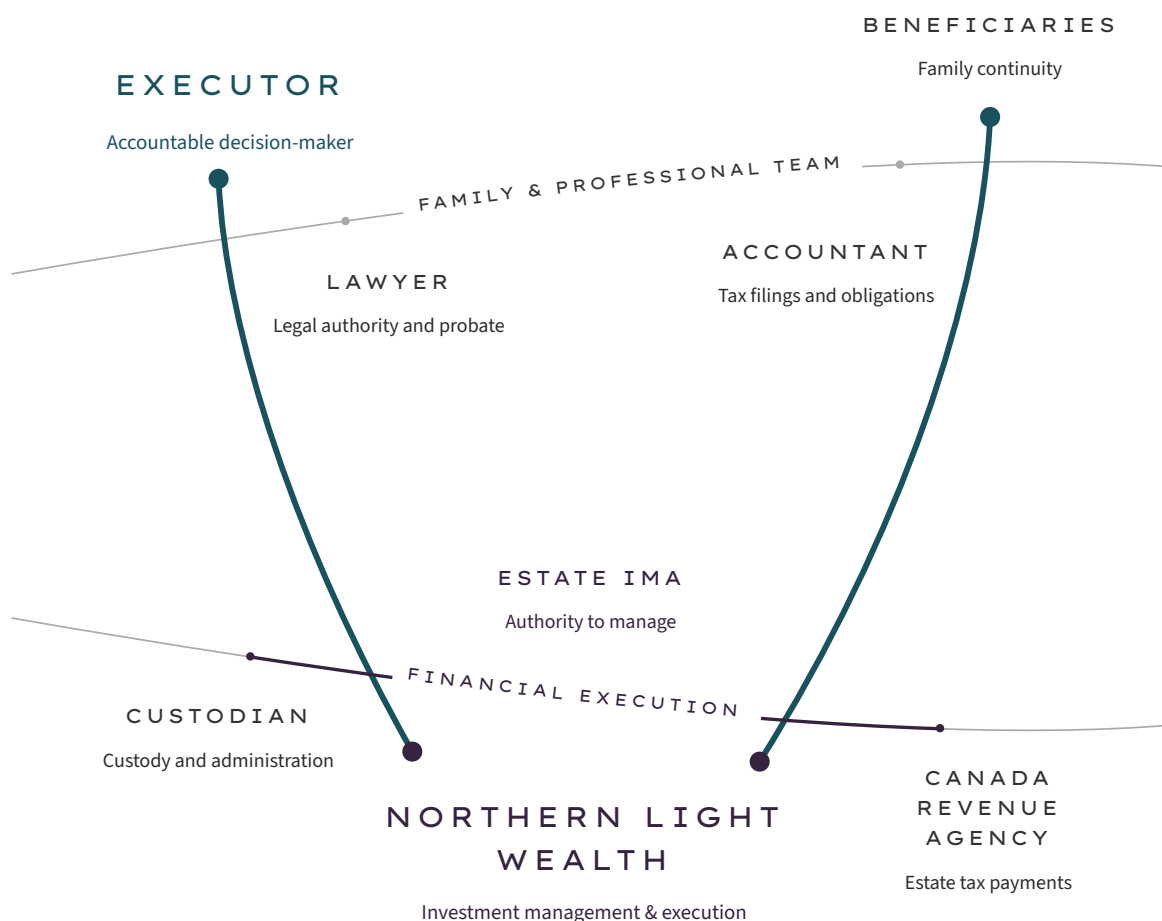
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With the current Will and an Estate Investment Management Agreement (Estate IMA) in place, Northern Light and the Executor can get to work while probate continues.

## PHASE 2 · FINANCIAL CONTINUITY

# Estates don't stand still at Northern Light.

Probate can take time. The estate still has bills to pay, taxes to fund and investments to manage. Northern Light designed the Estate IMA to keep the financial logistics moving for the Executor, family and their professional team.



This is where preparation becomes action.

The Estate IMA does not replace probate or expand the Executor's legal authority.

## PHASE 3 · ESTATE STEWARDSHIP

# Completing the stewardship.

By the time probate is granted, much of the financial work may already be underway. Probate allows the Executor to move toward beneficiary distributions and bring the estate toward completion.

## WHILE PROBATE IS UNDERWAY

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Investments remain managed

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Cash can be raised

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Taxes and estate obligations can be paid

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## ONCE PROBATE IS GRANTED

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Beneficiary distributions can begin

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Remaining assets can be transferred

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The estate can move toward completion

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Northern Light continues working alongside the Executor, lawyer and accountant through final distributions and the remaining financial work.

The objective is not simply to distribute assets.

It is to complete a lifetime of stewardship with the same care that shaped it.

## BEFORE OR AFTER

# Families are ready when they are ready. Estates cannot wait forever.

EstateReady can begin while everyone can still participate,  
or when an Executor needs to act.

## BEFORE

## Start the conversation while everyone can still participate.

Bring the family, Executor and professional team together. Organize the important information and create clarity before responsibility arrives.

## AFTER

## Start when responsibility has already arrived.

When responsibility arrives, Northern Light helps the Executor understand what needs attention, what can wait and how to keep the financial work moving.

## THE ESTATEREADY RESOURCE LIBRARY

Available through Northern Light, with practical resources for family conversations, Executor preparation, documents to gather and questions worth asking.

Bring the conversation to Northern Light.

[nlwealth.ca/estateready](https://nlwealth.ca/estateready)



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